Picking Colonies

PROTOCOL

1. **Photograph the plates** under blue-light transillumination and save the image. Once you have picked, this is the only record of what the colonies looked like.
2. Fill each well of the block with **4 mL 2YT + carb**.
3. Pick **4 colonies from each plate**: touch a sterile toothpick to a single colony and drop the toothpick into the well. It stays in.
   - **Pick in labsheet order, left to right.** The block layout has to match the data-entry layout — if it does not, nothing errors, the results are just silently scrambled.
   - **Well-isolated colonies only.** Never a small one beside a big one; that is a satellite and usually has no plasmid.
   - **Do not pick by brightness.** Choosing the brightest and then correlating against a prediction is circular.
4. Write the labels on an **airpore sheet** and cover the block with it.
5. Grow **overnight in the multitron**.
6. **Parafilm the plates** and store them **upside-down in the fridge** — you may need to go back to them.

- 6 plates × 4 colonies = **24 wells** of 24.
- Note why you picked each one (“very green, slow growing”).